PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Thursday, January 8, 2026

Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller (Committee Chair), Virginia LaForte, and Christy Splitt

Other Attendees:
Dr. Renard Adams – Chief Accountability and Equity Officer
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant; Board Clerk
Chris Brida – Director of CTE and Pathways
Jey Buno – Chief of Student Support Services
Yeng Dhabolt – Director, College and Career Readiness
Dr. Filip Hristić – Senior Director 9-12 Core Academics
Mary Kane – Senior Legal Counsel
Naomi Orem – Assistant Director, Multitiered Systems of Support (MTSS)
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer
Chandra Wilson-Cooper – Senior Director, Core Enrichment & Multitiered Systems of Support (MTSS)

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:35 pm by Committee Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller. Attendees introduced themselves.

Public Comment

Time: 4:37 pm

- Rachel Cermak – Urged the Board to allow students to take other rigorous and more interesting math classes in place of Algebra 3/4, noting that most colleges no longer require that class specifically.

Career Technical Education (CTE) / College Career Readiness

Time: 4:40 pm

Staff: Dr. Renard Adams, Christopher Brida, Yeng Dhabolt, Dr. Filip Hristić

Staff presented an overview of the district's Career and Technical Education and College and Career Readiness programs, highlighting program scale, expanded access to advanced coursework, growth in student participation, and strong outcomes in graduation, credential attainment, and college credit accumulation. The presentation emphasized increased enrollment in career pathways, rising completion rates, expanded opportunities for dual credit, Advanced Placement, and International Baccalaureate coursework, growth in access for historically underserved students, and the development of a nationally

unique literacy initiative embedded within CTE instruction to strengthen technical reading, writing, and knowledge acquisition.

Board members asked questions and shared feedback related to access, student outcomes, staffing capacity, and long-term sustainability of the programs. Discussion reflected support for the district's approach to preparing students for a range of postsecondary options, including college, workforce entry, and industry pathways, while noting the importance of maintaining staffing, expanding equitable access, and continuing to strengthen program quality and alignment.

Attendance Overview

Time: 5:13 pm

Staff: Naomi Orem and Chandra Wilson-Cooper

Staff provided an overview of districtwide attendance trends and efforts to address chronic absenteeism, highlighting the importance of engaging instruction, positive school climate, and coordinated school-based supports. The presentation outlined the district's overall approach to improving attendance, including the use of data, targeted strategies for identified student groups, and partnerships to support students and families.

Board members asked questions and provided comments on attendance patterns, communication with families, differences across schools and student groups, and the effectiveness of current strategies. There was discussion regarding barriers to attendance and the need for continued focus on targeted supports, data-informed decision making, and family engagement to improve student attendance outcomes.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 5:48 pm by Committee Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools